

HTA Platform User Manual

Version 3.0

Installation & Getting Started

Draft for Final User Manual

Document Control

Document	HTA Platform User Manual
Version	3.0
Section	Installation & Getting Started
Audience	End Users
Platforms	Windows / macOS
Status	Working Draft

Purpose

This manual explains how to install, configure and launch the HTA Platform. It is written for users with minimal programming experience.

1. System Requirements

- Visual Studio Code
- Python 3.11
- Git (optional)
- Ghostscript
- Ollama
- Internet connection (for supported features)

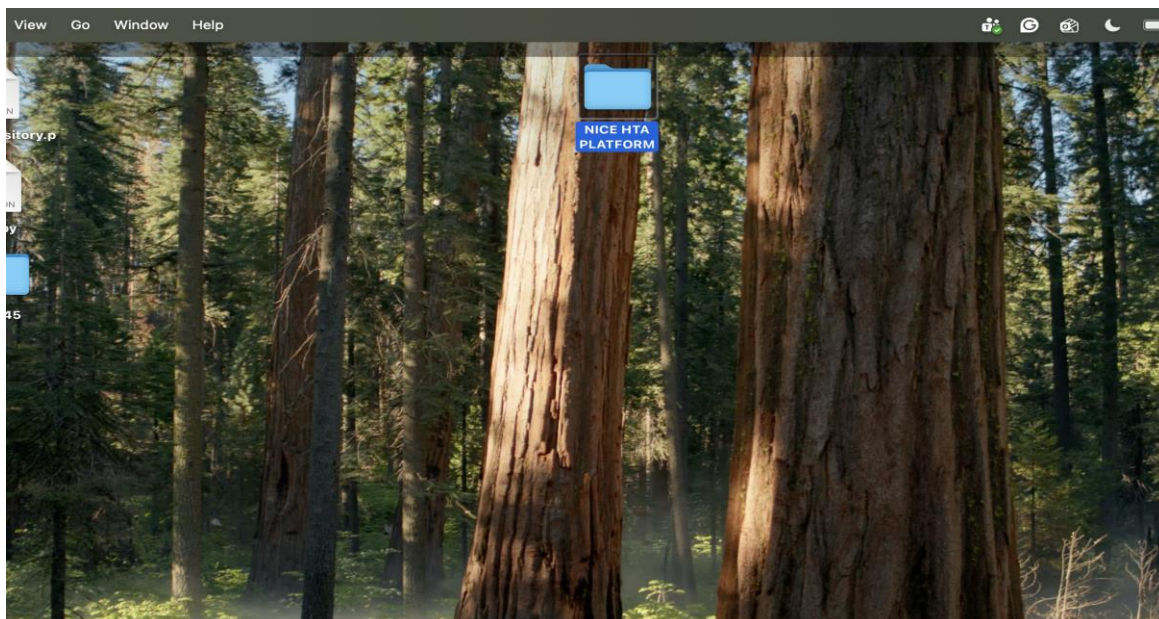
Daily Startup Checklist

1. Open Visual Studio Code.
2. Open the NICE HTA PLATFORM project.
3. Activate the virtual environment.
4. Verify Ollama is available if using AI features.
5. Run the Streamlit command.
6. Open the Local URL in your web browser.

2. Open the Project

1. Open Visual Studio Code.
2. Select File → Open Folder.
3. Choose the 'NICE HTA PLATFORM' folder.
4. Confirm that the project files appear in the Explorer panel.

Figure 2.1 – Opening the Project Folder – create a folder with given name – NICE HTA PLATFORM and SAVE ALL THE DOCUMENTS IN THIS DESKTOP FOLDER – EXTRACT CODING FILES FROM GIVEN COMPRESSED FILE. Then open V S Code and access the folder.



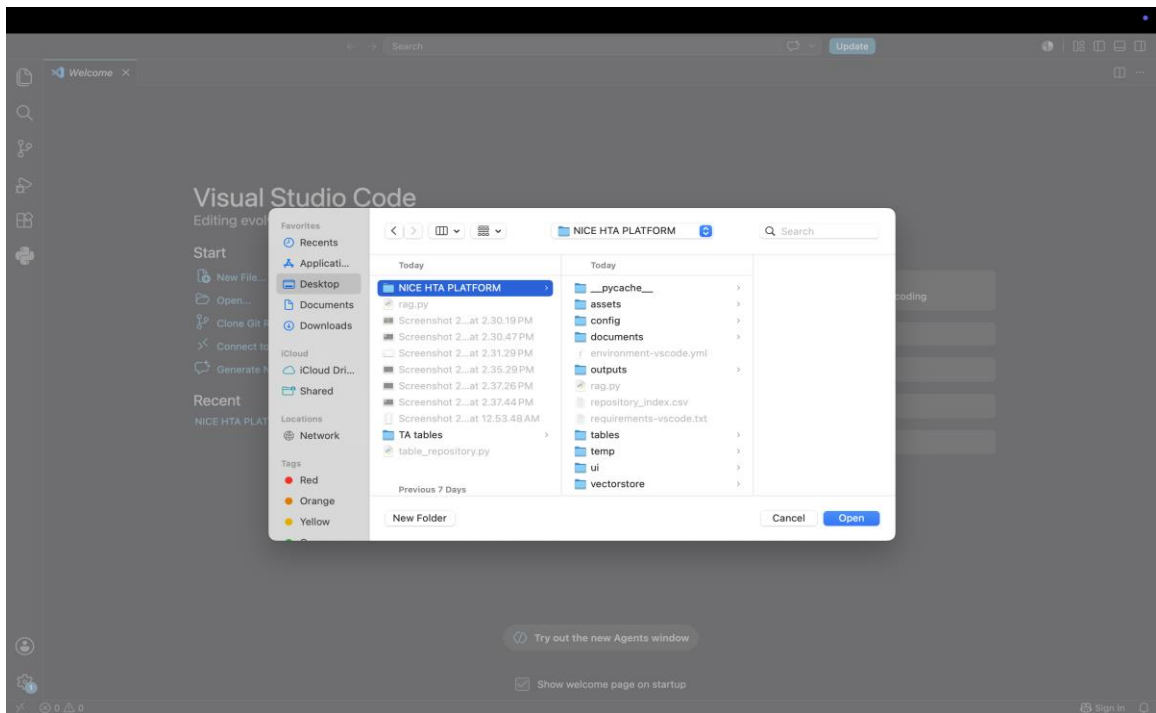
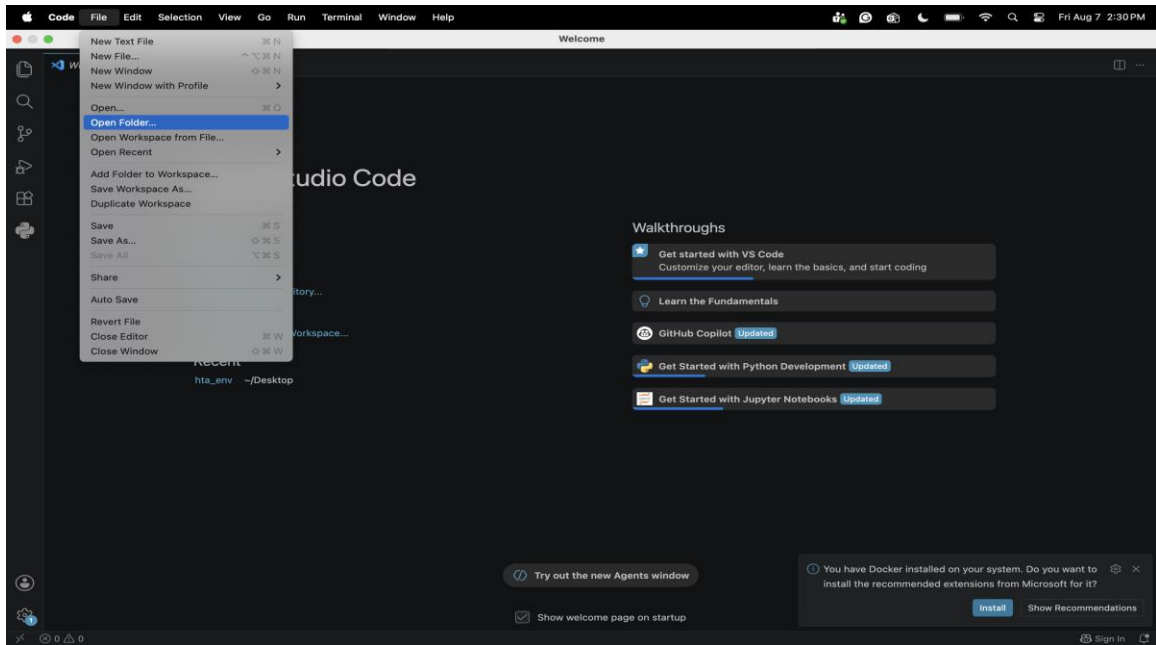
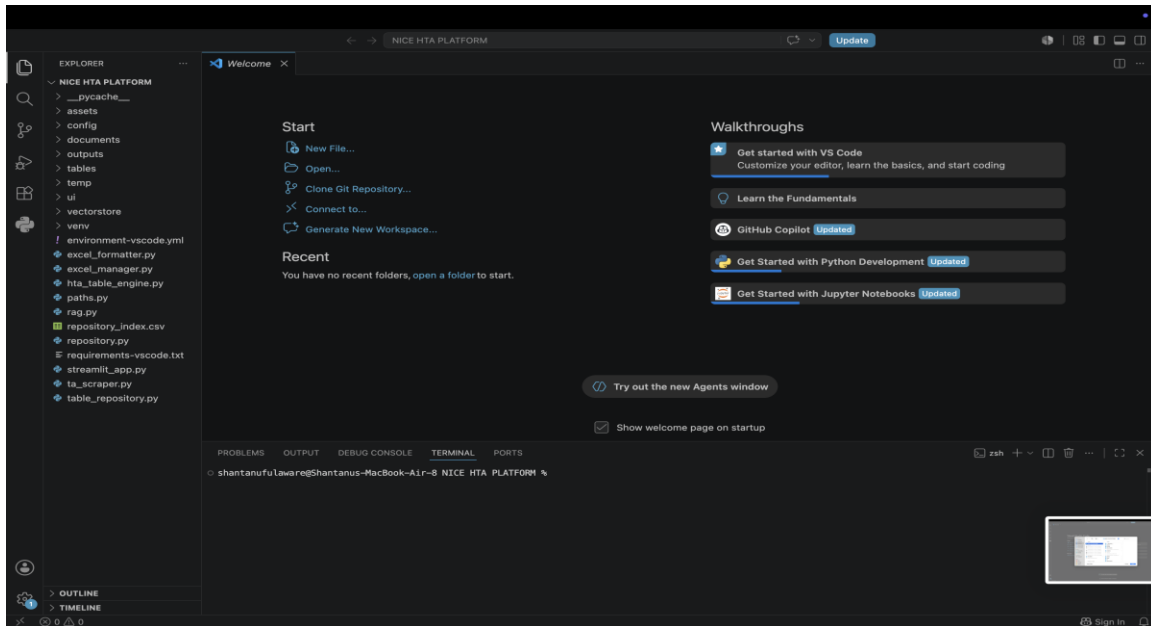


Figure 2.2 – Project Explorer / [Project Structure – Kindly note that ui folder contains rag_panel.py ; table_extraction.py; web_scraper.py]. Rest all the files will be in project root. Only ui folder will be created manually and rest all folders will be created automatically.



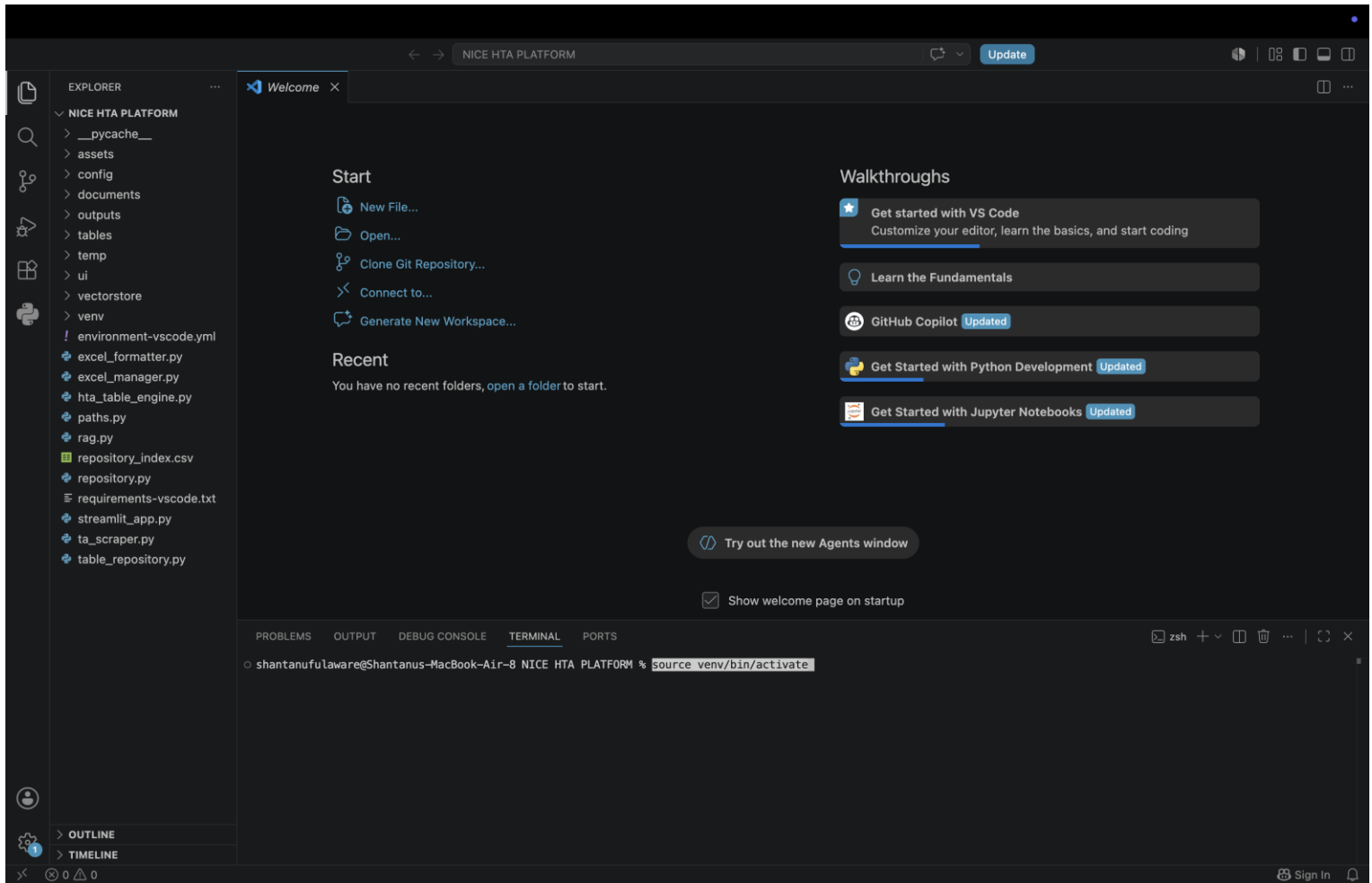
3. Activate the Python Virtual Environment

Open a new terminal in Visual Studio Code and run:

Command - source venv/bin/activate

When successful, the terminal prompt begins with (venv).

Figure 3.1 – Activated Virtual Environment



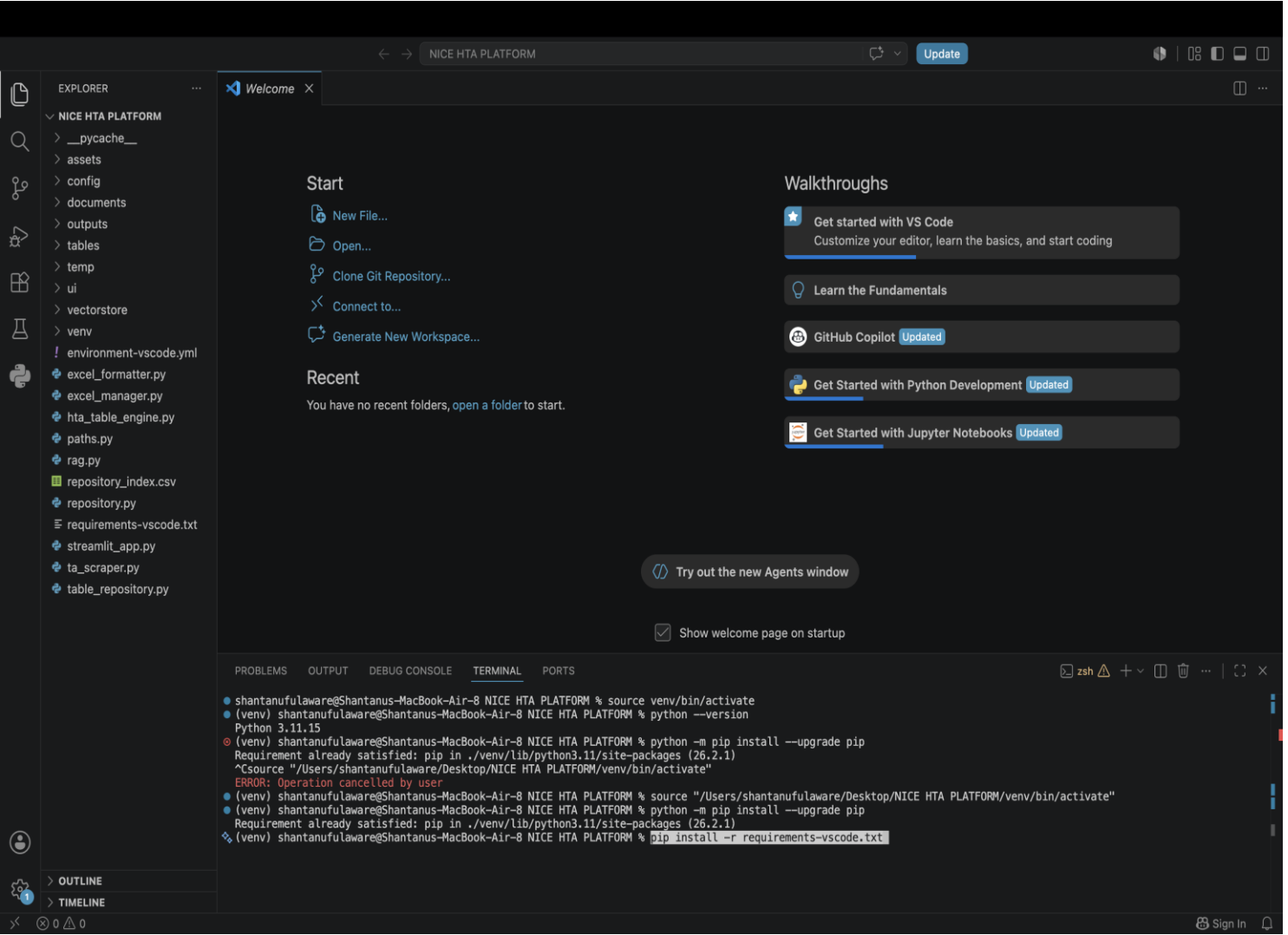
4. Install Project Dependencies

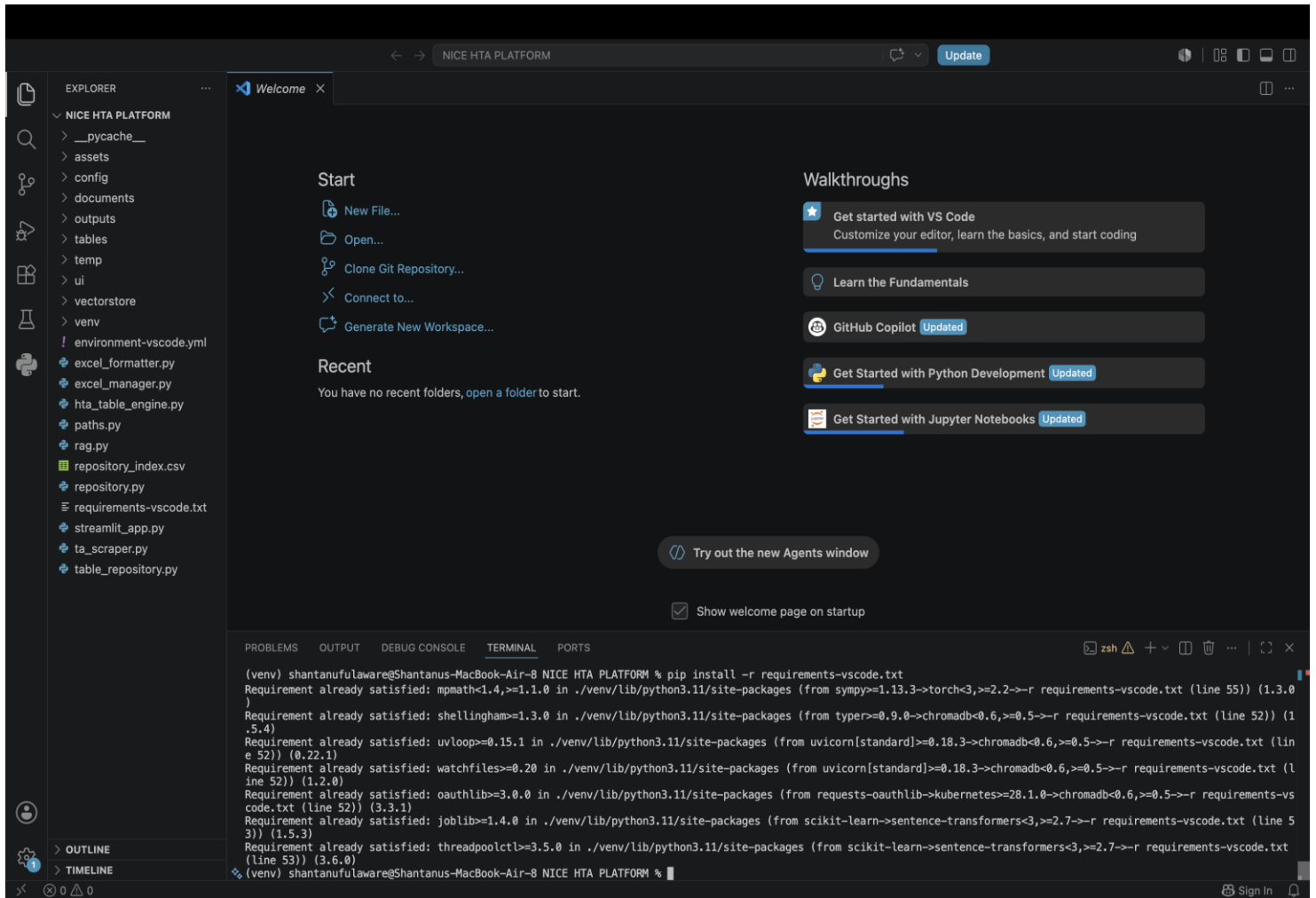
Run the following command once:

Command - `pip install -r requirements-vscode.txt`

If all packages are already installed, pip will display 'Requirement already satisfied' for each package.

Figure 4.1 – Dependency Installation





5. Verify Supporting Software

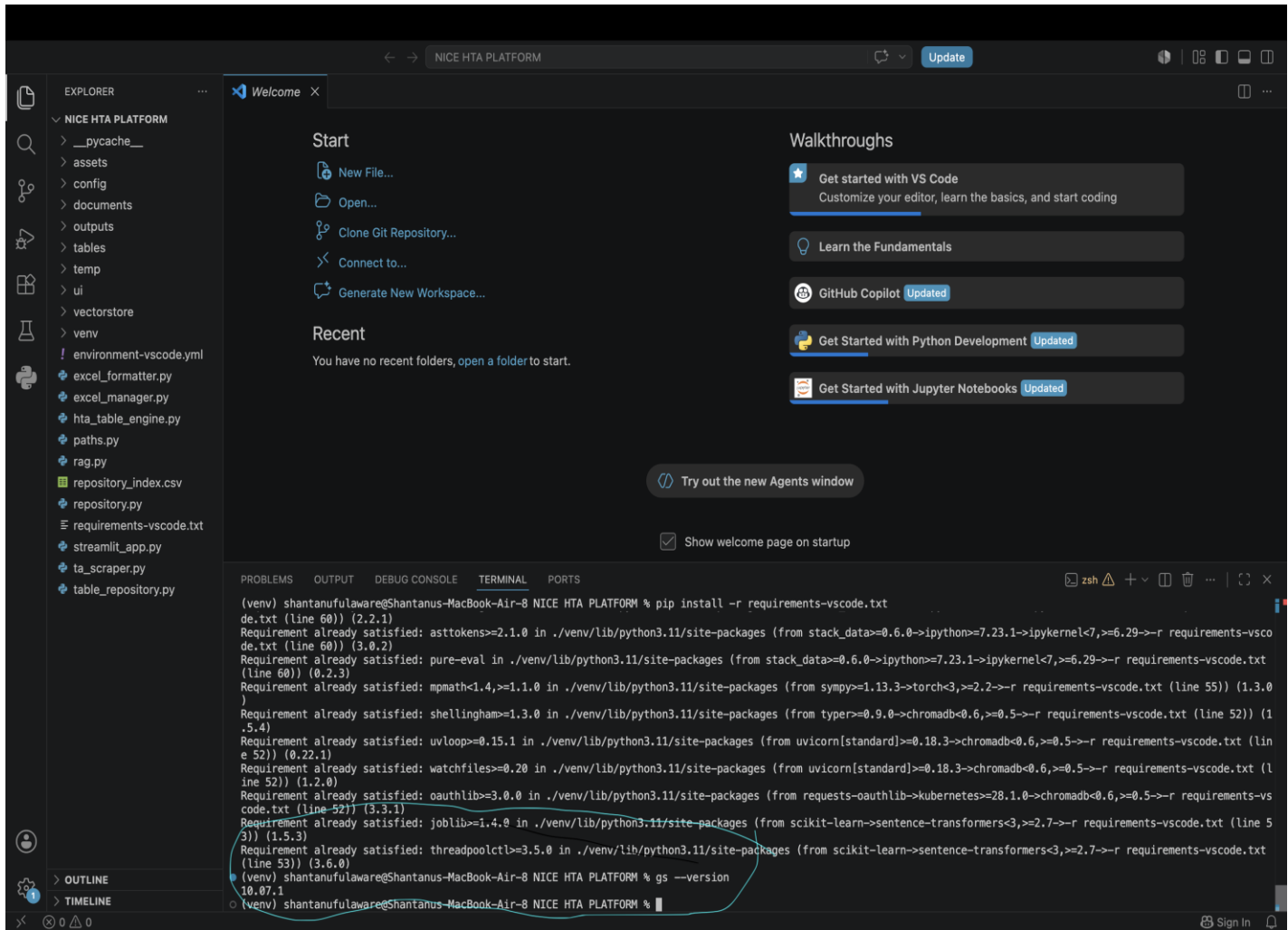
Ghostscript

Run:

Command - `gs --version`

A version number confirms successful installation.

Figure 5.1 – Ghostscript Verification



Ollama

Run:

Command - ollama list

Confirm that the required model is listed.

Figure 5.2 – Ollama Verification

```

Last login: Fri Aug 7 16:24:09 on console
shantanu@shantanu:~$ ollama serve
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.709+05:30 level=INFO source=routes.go:1802 msg="server config" env="map[HTTPS_PROXY: HTTP_PROXY: NO_PROXY: OLLAMA_CONTEXT_LENGTH:0 OLLAMA_DEBUG:INFO OLLAMA_DEBUG_LOG_REQUESTS:false OLLAMA_EDITOR: OLLAMA_FLASH_ATTENTION:false OLLAMA_GPU_OVERHEAD:0 OLLAMA_HOST:http://127.0.0.1:11434 OLLAMA_KEEP_ALIVE:5m0s OLLAMA_KV_CACHE_TYPE: OLLAMA_LLM_LIBRARY: OLLAMA_LOAD_TIMEOUT:5m0s OLLAMA_MAX_LOADED_MODELS:0 OLLAMA_MAX_QUEUE:512 OLLAMA_MAX_TRANSFER_STREAMS:4 OLLAMA_MODELS:/Users/shantanu@shantanu/.ollama/models OLLAMA_MULTUSER_CACHE:false OLLAMA_NEW_ENGINE:false OLLAMA_NOHISTORY:false OLLAMA_NOPRUNE:false OLLAMA_NO_CLOUD:false OLLAMA_NUM_PARALLEL:1 OLLAMA_ORIGINS:(http://localhost https://localhost+ https://localhost+ https://127.0.0.1 https://127.0.0.1 https://127.0.0.1 https://127.0.0.1) http://0.0.0.0 https://0.0.0.0 https://0.0.0.0 app:// file:// tauri:// vscode-webview:// vscode-file:// OLLAMA_REMOTES:ollama.com] OLLAMA_SCHED_SPREAD:false http_proxy: https_proxy: no_proxy:}"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.709+05:30 level=INFO source=routes.go:1806 msg="Ollama cloud disabled: false"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.713+05:30 level=INFO source=images.go:617 msg="total blobs: 27"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.713+05:30 level=INFO source=images.go:624 msg="total unused blobs removed: 0"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.714+05:30 level=INFO source=routes.go:1864 msg="listening on 127.0.0.1:11434 (version 0.23.4)"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.715+05:30 level=INFO source=runner.go:67 msg="discovering available GPUs..."
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.717+05:30 level=INFO source=server.go:433 msg="starting runner" cmd="/opt/homebrew/Cellar/ollama/0.23.4/libexec/ollama runner --ollama-engine --port 49635"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.830+05:30 level=INFO source=types.go:42 msg="inference compute" id=0 filter_id=0 library=Metal compute=0.0 name=Metal description="Apple M4" libdirs="" driver=0.0 pci_id="" type=discr
ete total="10.7 GiB" available="10.7 GiB"
time=2026-08-07T15:12:29.830+05:30 level=INFO source=routes.go:1914 msg="vram-based default context" total_vram="10.7 GiB" default_num_ctx=4096

```



6. Start the HTA Platform

Run:

Command - `python -m streamlit run streamlit_app.py`

Open the Local URL displayed in the terminal (typically `http://localhost:8501`).

Figure 6.1 – Launching Streamlit

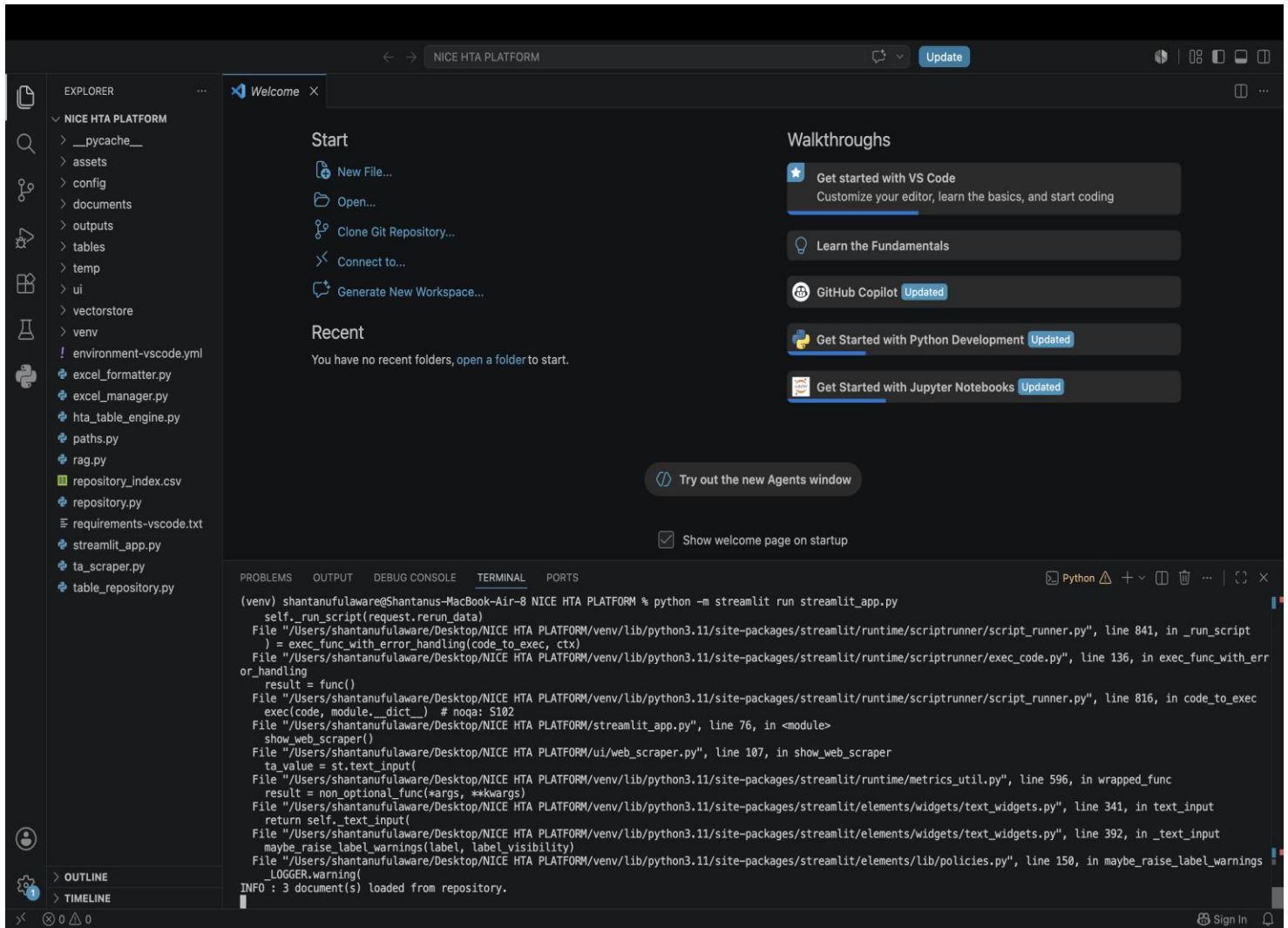


Figure 6.2 – HTA Platform Home Screen

NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM

 Web Scaper
  Document Repository & Table Extraction
  RAG Question Answering

TA Web Scraper

Reference Excel

Currently using reference Excel: [ta-recommendations.xlsx](#)

Replace Reference Excel

Enter TA Number / NICE URL

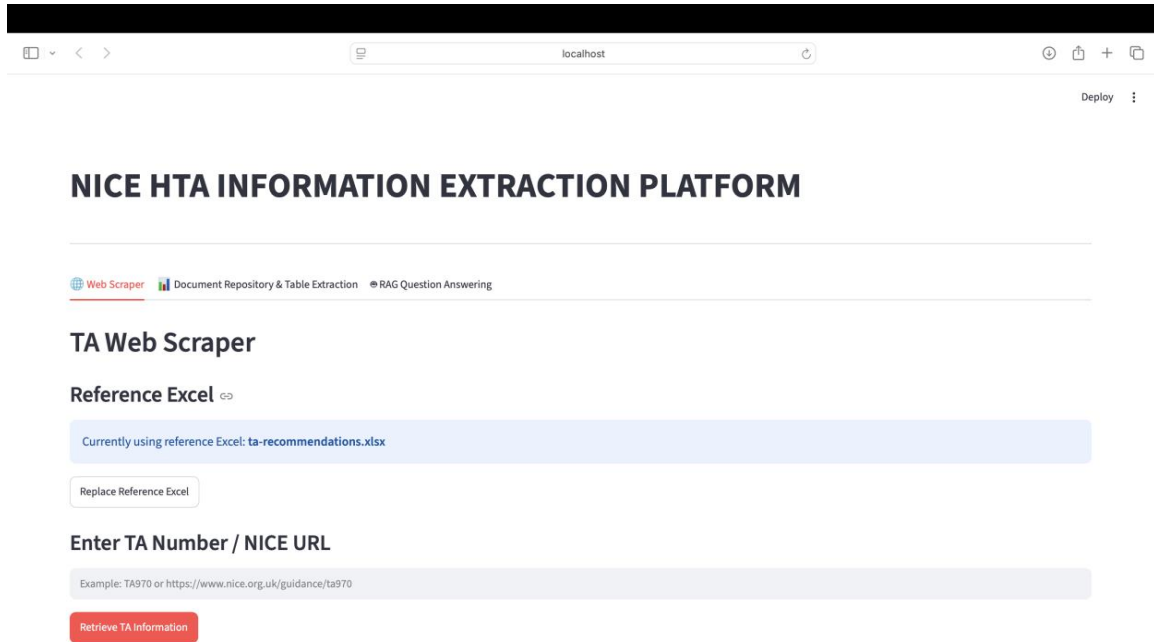
Example: TA970 or <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ta970>

7. TA Web Scraper

The TA Web Scraper retrieves information from NICE Technology Appraisal (TA) guidance pages using a TA number or NICE guidance URL. Users can upload or replace a reference Excel file, enter a TA identifier, retrieve information, review the results, and download them as CSV or Excel.

Steps:

1. Open the 'TA Web Scraper' tab.



The screenshot shows a web browser window displaying the 'NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM'. The browser's address bar shows 'localhost'. The page has a navigation bar with links for 'Web Scraper', 'Document Repository & Table Extraction', and 'RAG Question Answering'. The 'Web Scraper' section is active. Below the navigation bar, the title 'TA Web Scraper' is displayed. Underneath, there is a 'Reference Excel' section with a status bar indicating 'Currently using reference Excel: ta-recommendations.xlsx' and a 'Replace Reference Excel' button. Below this is an 'Enter TA Number / NICE URL' section with a text input field containing the example 'TA970 or https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ta970' and a 'Retrieve TA information' button.

2. Upload or replace the reference Excel if required. (REFERENCE EXCEL IS ATTACHED IN THE MAIL – REFER ta-recommendations excel)

3. Enter a TA number (e.g. TA970) or a NICE guidance URL.

localhost

Deploy

NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM

[Web Scraper](#) [Document Repository & Table Extraction](#) [RAG Question Answering](#)

TA Web Scraper

Reference Excel

Currently using reference Excel: ta-recommendations.xlsx

Replace Reference Excel

Enter TA Number / NICE URL

TA 1063 Press Enter to apply

Retrieve TA Information

4. Select 'Retrieve TA Information'.

localhost

Deploy

NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM

[Web Scraper](#) [Document Repository & Table Extraction](#) [RAG Question Answering](#)

TA Web Scraper

Reference Excel

Currently using reference Excel: ta-recommendations.xlsx

Replace Reference Excel

Enter TA Number / NICE URL

TA 1063 Press Enter to apply

Retrieve TA Information

5. Review the extracted information.

localhost

Deploy

Replace Reference Excel

Enter TA Number / NICE URL

TA 1069

Retrieve TA Information

Results

Field	Result
TA NUMBER	TA1069
Title	Efgartigimod for treating antibody-positive generalised myasthenia gravis
Disease Area	None
Disease Sub-Area	None
Technology Name	Efgartigimod
Publication Date	04 June 2025
Last Updated	None
NICE Recommendation	1.1 Efgartigimod is not recommended, within its marketing authorisation, as an add-on to standard treatment for generalised myasther
Appraisal Process	STA
Recommendation	Not recommended
Technology Type	Pharmaceutical

Download CSVDownload Excel

6. Download the results as CSV or Excel.

localhost

Deploy

Replace Reference Excel

Enter TA Number / NICE URL

TA 1069

Retrieve TA Information

Results

Field	Result
TA NUMBER	TA1069
Title	Efgartigimod for treating antibody-positive generalised myasthenia gravis
Disease Area	None
Disease Sub-Area	None
Technology Name	Efgartigimod
Publication Date	04 June 2025
Last Updated	None
NICE Recommendation	1.1 Efgartigimod is not recommended, within its marketing authorisation, as an add-on to standard treatment for generalised myasther
Appraisal Process	STA
Recommendation	Not recommended
Technology Type	Pharmaceutical

Download CSVDownload Excel

8. Document Repository and Table Extraction

This module discovers NICE documents, downloads selected files, maintains a local repository, previews PDFs, and extracts tables from downloaded documents.

- Workflow:
1. Discover documents.

localhost

Deploy

NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM

Web Scraper

Document Repository & Table Extraction

RAG Question Answering

Document Repository & Table Extraction

Discover NICE documents, download PDF files, extract tables and browse the extracted table repository.

Discover NICE Documents

NICE Technology Appraisal

TA 1069

Press Enter to apply

Discover Documents

localhost

Deploy

Discover NICE documents, download PDF files, extract tables and browse the extracted table repository.

Discover NICE Documents

NICE Technology Appraisal

TA1069

Discover Documents

30 document(s) discovered successfully.

Select Documents

Select	TA Number	Document ID	Document Name	File Type	Download Status
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC001	Guidance PDF	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC002	Appeal letter - argenx : Appeal letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC003	Scrutiny letter - argenx : Scrutiny letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC004	Response to scrutiny letter - argenx : Response to scrutiny letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC005	Final scrutiny letter - argenx : Final scrutiny letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC006	Appeal letter - myaware UK : Appeal letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC007	Scrutiny letter - myaware UK : Scrutiny letter	OTHER	Not Downloaded

2. Select and download documents.

localhost

Deploy

Select	TA Number	Document ID	Document Name	File Type	Download Status
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC021	Draft guidance	PDF	Not Downloaded
☒	TA1069	TA1069_DOC022	Committee papers	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC023	Public committee slides	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC024	Draft guidance	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC025	Final scope	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC026	Final stakeholder list	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC027	NICE's response to comments on the draft scope and provisional stakeholder list	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC028	Equality impact assessment	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC029	Draft scope post referral	PDF	Not Downloaded
☐	TA1069	TA1069_DOC030	Draft matrix post referral	PDF	Not Downloaded

Download Selected Documents

Table Extraction

Please download a document before extracting tables.

3. Preview or download PDFs.

localhost

Deploy

Download Selected Documents

☒ 1 document(s) downloaded successfully.

Selected Document

☒ Committee papers is now available.

Preview PDF

Download PDF

Table Extraction

Page Range

From

1

To

20

Extract Tables

4. Specify a page range.

localhost

Deploy

Download Selected Documents

✓ 1 document(s) downloaded successfully.

Selected Document

✓ Committee papers is now available.

Preview PDF

Download PDF

Table Extraction

Page Range

From

1

-

+

To

50

Press Enter to apply

-

+

Extract Tables

5. Extract tables.

localhost

Deploy

1

+

50

+

Extract Tables

20 table(s) extracted successfully.

Table Repository

Extracted Tables

20

Merged Pages

28

Total Rows

110

Select Table

Table 1 (Page 4)

Table 1 (Page 4)

Table 1 (Page 12)

Table 2 (Page 14)

Table 4 (Page 17)

Table 3 (Page 18)

Table 4 (Page 19)

Table 5 (Page 22)

Table 6 (Page 26)

7. Browse and export extracted tables. – click download excel for single table download and download all for all the tables download in one excel.

localhost

Deploy

Table Name	14 February 2023
Start Page	4
End Page	4
Merged Pages	4
Rows	2
Columns	4

Table Preview

0	1	2	3
File name	Version	Contains confidential information	Date
ID4003_Vyvgart_gMG_Document B_v2.0_[redacted]	2.0	No	28 February 2023

Download Table

Download CSV

Download Excel

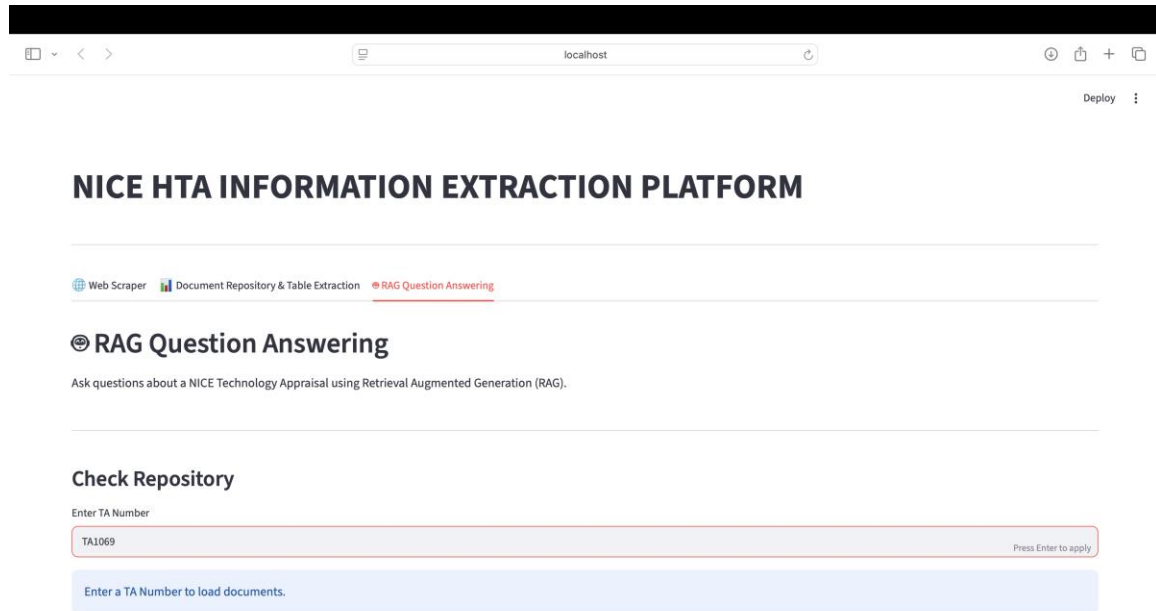
Download All

9. RAG Question Answering

The RAG module enables users to ask questions about downloaded NICE PDF documents. After selecting a document and page range, build the RAG pipeline and submit natural language questions. Answers are returned together with supporting evidence and performance metrics.

Typical workflow:

1. Select a TA.



The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar set to localhost. The page title is "NICE HTA INFORMATION EXTRACTION PLATFORM". Below the title, there is a navigation bar with three items: "Web Scraper", "Document Repository & Table Extraction", and "RAG Question Answering" (which is highlighted with a red underline). The main heading is "RAG Question Answering" with a subtext: "Ask questions about a NICE Technology Appraisal using Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)". Below this, there is a section titled "Check Repository" with a subtext "Enter TA Number". A text input field contains the value "TA1069" and a button labeled "Press Enter to apply". At the bottom, there is a light blue box with the text "Enter a TA Number to load documents."

2. Choose a downloaded PDF.

Web ScraperDocument Repository & Table ExtractionRAG Question Answering

RAG Question Answering

Ask questions about a NICE Technology Appraisal using Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG).

Check Repository

Enter TA Number

TA1069

Available Documents

Select Document

TA1069_DOC022 - Committee papers

TA1069_DOC022 - Committee papers

TA1069_DOC001 - Guidance PDF

TA1069_DOC011 - Final draft guidance

Page Range

From

1

-

+

To

20

-

+

3. Build the RAG pipeline.

localhost

Deploy

Check Repository

Enter TA Number

TA1069

Available Documents

Select Document

TA1069_DOC022 - Committee papers

Process Document

Page Range

From

1

To

500

Press Enter to apply

Process Document

localhost

Deploy

Check Repository

Enter TA Number

TA1069

Available Documents

Select Document

TA1069_DOC022 - Committee papers

Process Document

Page Range

From

1

To

500

Process Document

RAG pipeline ready.

4. Ask questions.

localhost

Deploy

Process Document

RAG pipeline ready.

Conversation

Ask Question

Question

what is the time horizon for the given intervention

Press **⌘**+**Enter** to apply

Ask Question

Clear Chat

Download Conversation

5. Review supporting evidence.

localhost

Deploy

Ask Question

Question

what is the cycle length for the given intervention

Ask Question

Clear Chat

Download Conversation

Supporting Evidence

Page	Chunks
90	284
97	311
170	559
205	669
302	914

Performance

6. Download the conversation if required.

localhost

Deploy

Ask Question

Clear Chat

Download Conversation

Supporting Evidence

Page	Chunks
90	284
97	311
170	559
205	669
302	914

Performance

Retrieved Chunks	Retrieval Time (s)	Response Time (s)
5	0.74	6.94

10. Troubleshooting and Best Practices

Common issues:

- Virtual environment not activated.
- Missing Python packages.
- Ollama not running.
- No downloaded PDF available.
- Invalid TA number or network connection.

Best practices:

- Keep dependencies updated.
- Verify supporting software before launching.
- Download documents before table extraction or RAG.
- Use appropriate page ranges for faster processing.
- Regularly back up repository data and exported outputs.